LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH JUNIOR (K–2) BEGINNER: LITTLE CODERS

Lesson 1: Arrows Tell Me Where to Go

Module 1 | 30 minutes | Sequence | KG–Grade 2 · ages 5–7

Objective: Use arrow blocks to move a character, and put blocks in order to reach a goal.

Success criteria

- I can move a character with arrow blocks.
- I can put blocks in order.
- I can count steps to a goal.

Key vocabulary

- **code**: Instructions for a computer.
- **block**: One instruction, like a puzzle piece.
- **sequence**: Blocks in order, one after another.
- **arrow**: Shows which way to move.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (30 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Floor robot (5 min): one child is the “robot” and follows arrow cards held up by the class.
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	Move the cat in ScratchJr: learners follow the steps.
5 min	**Perform**	To the star, Up the tree, Which way?, Be a robot
3 min	**Probe**	Round the corner
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: Show me the arrow that moves the cat up.

Unplugged warm-up

Floor robot (5 min): one child is the “robot” and follows arrow cards held up by the class.

Teaching the idea

Sequence: a program is blocks in order, run one after another. ScratchJr motion blocks move one grid square per step. K–2 learners map arrows to directions and count squares.

Analogy: A treasure map: follow the arrows in order.

Live demo: Use a big floor grid (tape on the carpet). A child is the cat; the class holds up arrow cards in order.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Which arrow moves up?	The up arrow.
How many arrows to go 3 squares?	Three.
What if we swap the order?	The cat goes a different way.

Differentiation

Support
Use a printed grid and let children slide a counter for each block before tapping Run.

Stretch
Make the longest path you can to the star, then the shortest.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Left and right mean the child's left/right when facing the screen	Point to the arrow's direction on the screen.
The cat does all blocks at once	One block at a time, in order.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

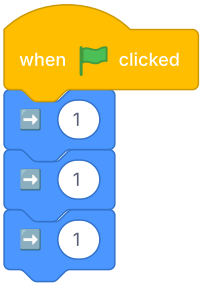
Exit ticket
Show me the arrow that moves the cat up.

Homework
Draw a map from your bed to the door with arrows.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

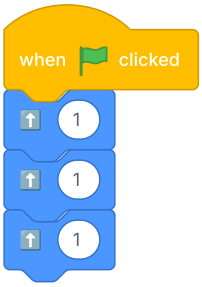
1. To the star (perform · block code)

One solution:



2. Up the tree (perform · block code)

One solution:



3. Which way? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: ➡️ right

4. Round the corner (probe · block code)

One solution:



5. Be a robot (perform · speaking)

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** code = Instructions for a computer. · block = One instruction, like a puzzle piece. · sequence = Blocks in order, one after another. · arrow = Shows which way to move.
2. **Which way?:** A. ➡️ right — The fish is to the right, so the cat moves right.
3. **Draw the path:** ➡️ ➡️ ➡️ ⬆️ ⬆️ (or ⬆️ ⬆️ ➡️ ➡️ ➡️)

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.